



Questionnaire: Expedia - CarTrawler

MN-90022

Deadline to respond: 28 July 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing Expedia Group, Inc. (**Expedia**)'s proposed acquisition of 100% of the entire issued share capital in Ballast Group Holdings Ltd (trading as **CarTrawler**) (the **Acquisition**).

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's [Acquisitions Register](#).

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by **28 July 2026** via email to mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: Expedia - CarTrawler*. The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@acc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: Expedia - CarTrawler*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.
- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's [general confidentiality claims template](#)). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

1. Outline any concerns regarding the impact of the Acquisition on competition, including the products your concerns relate to, whether Expedia and CarTrawler are close competitors and there are not many alternatives, or whether one is a major supplier to competitors of the other.

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2. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition.

3. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationships with Expedia and/or CarTrawler.

4. Outline what alternatives you consider there to be to CarTrawler's services, including any relative strengths and weaknesses of these alternatives compared to CarTrawler's services.

5. Outline what alternatives you consider there to be to Expedia's intermediation distribution solutions in respect of lodging, flights, activities, and related services, including any relative strengths or weaknesses of these alternatives compared to Expedia's services.

Questions for customers of B2B car rental distribution services

6. What would be involved in switching from one provider of B2B car rental distribution services (such as CarTrawler's Connect platform) to another? Please consider factors such as costs to switch, quality of services provided, and the extent to which it is possible to implement a solution which allows integration with multiple B2B car rental distribution service providers.

7. In the event that CarTrawler's Connect platform was only available when used with other related Expedia services (for example, Expedia's B2B intermediation distribution solutions in respect of lodging, flights, activities, etc.), would this affect your choice of provider for those related services? Explain why/why not, including any barriers to changing providers.

8. In the event that CarTrawler's Connect platform was not available on a standalone basis and was instead incorporated into Expedia's OTA customer offering, to what extent would this affect your ability to compete for customers? Explain why/why not, including for which customers.

Questions for suppliers of B2B car rental distribution services

9. Explain to what extent interoperability with Expedia's OTA platform is relevant to your ability to compete for end customers.

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's [Quick guide on providing confidential information to the ACCC](#).